

IT Incident Management Policy

Policy No: POL-IT-007 | Version: v2.2 | Department: IT Operations & Security | Effective: March 17, 2026

1. PURPOSE

This policy defines the process for identifying, reporting, responding to, and learning from IT incidents. A structured incident management process minimizes business impact, reduces recovery time, and prevents recurrence.

2. SCOPE

This policy applies to all IT systems, applications, and services managed by or on behalf of the organization, and all employees who may encounter or report IT incidents.

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4. INCIDENT CLASSIFICATION

Incidents are classified by severity to ensure appropriate response urgency:

P1 - Critical (Response: Immediate / 15 min)

- Complete system outage affecting all users or business-critical services.
- Active data breach or ransomware attack in progress.
- Core infrastructure failure (network, datacenter, primary database).

P2 - High (Response: 1 hour)

- Significant service degradation affecting multiple users or departments.
- Security incident with potential data exposure.
- Failure of business-critical application used by 25%+ of users.

P3 - Medium (Response: 4 hours)

- Partial service degradation affecting a team or project.
- Non-critical system failure with available workaround.

P4 - Low (Response: Next business day)

- Minor issues affecting individual users with minimal business impact.
- Service requests, questions, and non-urgent changes.

5. REPORTING PROCESS

All IT incidents must be reported through official channels. Do not attempt to resolve incidents independently without IT involvement.

5.1 Reporting Channels

- IT Helpdesk Portal: helpdesk.company.com (preferred for P3/P4).
- Email: itsupport@company.com (for P3/P4).
- Phone: IT Helpdesk Ext. 1000 (for P1/P2 — 24/7).
- Emergency Hotline: 1800-IT-HELP (for P1 critical incidents outside business hours).

5.2 Information to Include in Report

- Date, time, and description of the incident.
- Systems, applications, and users affected.
- Any error messages or screenshots if available.
- Actions already taken (if any).

6. INCIDENT RESPONSE PROCEDURE

6.1 Phase 1 - Identification & Logging

Incident is logged in the ITSM system with priority classification, assigned incident number, and initial description. All communication is tracked in the incident ticket.

6.2 Phase 2 - Containment

Immediate actions to prevent further damage: isolating affected systems, blocking suspicious accounts, preserving evidence, and implementing emergency access controls.

6.3 Phase 3 - Eradication

Root cause identification and elimination: removing malware, patching vulnerabilities, correcting misconfigurations, or rebuilding compromised systems.

6.4 Phase 4 - Recovery

Restoring systems to normal operation: from backup recovery, service restoration, user communication, and verification testing.

6.5 Phase 5 - Lessons Learned

Post-incident review within 5 business days for P1/P2 incidents to identify improvements.

7. ESCALATION MATRIX

- P4 Low: IT Support Analyst - Target resolution: 8 business hours.
- P3 Medium: Senior IT Engineer - Target resolution: 4 business hours.
- P2 High: IT Manager + Department Head - Target resolution: 2 hours.
- P1 Critical: CTO + IT Director + CISO + Executive Team - Target: 15 minutes response, 4 hours resolution.

Note: Escalation must occur if the incident is not resolved within 50% of the target resolution time.

8. POST-INCIDENT REVIEW

A Post-Incident Review (PIR) or Root Cause Analysis (RCA) is mandatory for all P1 and P2 incidents.

- PIR must be completed within 5 business days of incident resolution.
- RCA report must include: timeline, root cause, impact assessment, and prevention measures.
- Action items from PIR must be assigned to owners with deadlines.
- PIR findings are shared with relevant stakeholders and stored in the knowledge base.
- Recurring incidents require escalated investigation and systemic remediation.

9. ROLES & RESPONSIBILITIES

- All Employees: Report incidents promptly, cooperate with investigation, follow IT instructions.
- IT Support: First response, logging, initial triage, and resolution of P3/P4 incidents.
- IT Manager: Oversight of P1/P2 incidents, stakeholder communication, resource allocation.
- IT Security Team: Security incident investigation, forensics, regulatory reporting.
- CTO/IT Director: Executive escalation, major incident declaration, external communication.

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

EMPLOYEE ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

I, the undersigned, confirm that I have read, understood, and agree to comply with this policy. I understand that violation of this policy may result in disciplinary action.

Employee
Name: _____

Date: _____

Employee
ID: _____

Signature: _____

Department
: _____

Manager: _____

For questions regarding this policy, contact the IT Department at it-policy@company.com